MAY 2005

# Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

**P.O. Box 252**
**Mountain View, CA 94042**
**Trudi Tuban - Editor**



Southern Pacific Depot — Mountain View, California, built in 1888

## *MOUNTAIN VIEW'S LOW-LAND PIONEERS*

**Presented by**

### *MRS. BARBARA McPHEETERS KINCHEN*

**Barbara Kinchen, City Historian, will tell us about the people who first settled in the "low-lands" around Charleston and Stierlin Roads, just after California became a state. Now our North-Bayshore area is covered with hi-tech computer companies, Shoreline Park and the Amphitheatre instead of acres of hay and grain. You will hear about the importance of the bay itself and of the family names, such as Charleston, on streets, schools and parks.**

**Mrs. Kinchen was born and raised in Mountain View and her relatives settled in various parts of Santa Clara County in the early 1800's—including the low-lands of Mountain View.**

**After the presentation, there will be our usual opportunity for coffee, cookies and good fellowship. Please join us at the Adobe Building, Sunday, May 1, 2005 at 2pm.**

## PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE *BY NICK GALIOTTO*

**It was a pleasure, as Vice Mayor, to dedicate the new Water Tank House which completes the restoration of the Rengstorff House now situated in Shoreline Park. This Tank House was the project of the 'Friends of "R" House' and shows what a few motivated members of the community can accomplish with a lot of effort and perseverance. The dedication on March 21st was well attended in spite of some inclement weather and the Historical Association's donation to the project was noted during the program.**

Wally Erichsen is arranging a very interesting program for our regular meeting in May and John Viscovich is once more coordinating the great August Barbecue and Raffle. After the August Barbecue, our year will close with the Annual Meeting in November.

Be sure to read the details of these events in our excellent Newsletter, which is now under the editorship of Trudi Tuban. Please let Trudi know that we appreciate her efforts in keeping members connected and informed about our Association.

In our last Newsletter, I mentioned that Wally has made a challenge to explore the possibility of establishing a permanent Mountain View History Museum where artifacts and other memorabilia of earlier Mountain View (beyond that of the Library's History Room) could be stored and exhibited. Several members have stepped forward to join Wally's committee and he's looking for a few more participants. Remember what the 'Friends of "R" House' accomplished!

Again, encourage your friends to attend the meetings. They will learn of Mountain View's colorful past and mingle with some of those that have lived it. That's what we're about. Let's share the experience. See you on Sunday, May 1st!!

## *OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN*

Newspaper items from 1894 issues of "Palo Alto Times," "Mountain View Register" and the "San Jose Daily Mercury:"

"A little blurb about Mountain View – The chief products are: grain, vegetables, berries, fruits, wines and brandies. There are 18 wineries and distilleries at Mountain View and in its vicinity and no section of the state has a more enviable reputation for the products of its orchards and vineyards. A local brickyard and saw mill furnish the chief materials for building at cheap figures. The soil is rich and highly productive and land may be obtained at a low price in tracts to suit."

Post Office hours – Delivery window open 7:30 am to 7:30 pm week days, except at time of arrival and departure of mail. Open Sunday's 8:30 am to 12 Noon and 4:30 pm to 6 pm. Money orders available only week days. Dennis J. Murphy, Post Master

There are 200 sprinkled roads in the County…

Mountain View Grammar School had its largest enrollment ever, with 120 girls and 121 boys, with 19 students in the graduating class.

A "Sheet and Pillow Case" party was given by Professor Lucas in Carlin Hall. Ladies free, gents 50 cents.

The W.C.T.U. reports that Mountain View has 11 saloons.

Odd Fellows Lodge members have built a shed near their hall in Old Town for sheltering their horses on meeting nights.

At one of the local general stores, one could purchase feather dusters, wash boards, or Dover egg beaters for 10 cents each.

The Tyrolean Tourists, zither players, presented their "Grand Spiritual Tour of the World and Musical Melange," followed by a dance at Olympic Hall.

## *STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN*

The Josef Sladky family from Bohemia, Austria, owned many acres between Mira Monte and Springer Roads, now occupied by Blossom Plaza Shopping Center and subdivisions. What is now the part of Cuesta Drive between Springer and Mira Monte was opened in 1910 as Sladky Road. Much later, the road was extended to Grant Road. About 1955, there was a name change to Cuesta Drive.

Today's Sladky Avenue was once Central Avenue and was so named after the 1944 death of Miss Marie Sladky, last of the family, here since the mid 1880's. This street almost lost the name when, about 1960, residents petitioned to have it changed to Amber (as in Liquid Amber trees). While the City Planning Department favored the residents, the Council refused to erase the old family name.

*NEW QUESTION:* Which street was named for a long time Mountain View High School chemistry teacher (1925-1958) who served on the City Council and whose father was a noted astronomer at Lick Observatory, Mount Hamilton?

## HELP! HELP!

Who has a few hours on Tuesday afternoons to work with Edna Thompson and Barbara Kinchen in the Library's Mountain View History Center? Specifically, we need someone to file information cards. Louise Fallon enjoyed doing this work but moved to Santa Clara. While the job seems routine, it's never dull! We all get involved with interesting people with questions or information about Mountain View, past and present. Please speak to Edna or Barbara if interested.

## *EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE REPORT*

The Mountain View Historical Association Executive Committee met on March 23, 2005. The Treasurer's report for period ending March 23, 2005 was read and approved. The City has told us that they will be using a yearly rate versus a per-meeting rate for the 2005 insurance. It was reported that the Navy has taken responsibility for the hazmat cleanup of only the exterior of Hanger One at Moffett Field and that the inside cleanup will be mediated. Future events where the MVHA will have an information table were discussed. A progress report was given on the committee formation on the possibility of having a Mountain View Historical Museum.

*Synopsis of Income and Expense Report:*

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|---|---|
| Ending Balance as of December 4, 2004 | $32,534.88 |
| Adjusted Ending Balance (-Nov bill & Nov interest) | $32,409.06 |
| Ending Balance as of March 23, 2005 | $33,419.64 |

Please contact Pat Figueroa if you desire to see the full report.

## *NEW*

We are looking for new and interesting features for our Newsletter. We encourage members to submit short writings about their lives or Mountain View events or places. Please send your submittal to the Newsletter Editor for consideration.

## *MOUNTAIN VIEW SHELL OIL DEPOT BY MEMBER LOUIS BECK*

Manny Esparenza, Jack Tutman and Louis Beck were part of the crew working at the Shell Oil Company Depot located at Evelyn and Calderon Avenue, Mountain View.

In the 1920's, railroad cars or barges brought goods to a terminal and delivery by trucks was only used for the last 15 to 20 miles because trucks had a limited range because many of them were still using solid tires. For example, barges brought goods to the South Shore Port and then trucks delivered them through out Santa Clara County until the late 1920's. There were Shell Oil Company depots in San Francisco, Redwood City, Mountain View, San Jose, Salinas and Santa Cruz until after World War II. A depot was established at the Redwood City Port in 1949. Gasoline was brought to the Depot by barge from the refinery at Martinez and delivered by truck as far south as San Luis Obispo.

My father, Louis Beck, started working at the Mountain View Depot in 1930. Between 1934 and 1940, he worked at the Redwood City, Santa Cruz and San Jose Depots. He was called to active duty in the U. S. Navy in April 1940 and served until the spring of 1948. He returned to Shell until he retired in 1958.

Mountain View also had a Standard Oil Company Depot and there was a strong rivalry between Shell and Standard before World War II. I worked for Otto Krebs at his Standard station at El Camino Real and Castro Street in 1944 while I was in high school. It was suggested to my mother that my working for Standard might affect my father's job when he returned from the service.

Member Louis Beck, now living in Fresno submitted this article. Louis graduated from Mountain View High School in 1945 and his father, Louis Beck, graduated in 1926.



## *IN MEMORIAM*

***MILAN MATT POPOVICH:*** **Passed away at home in Saratoga on January 20, 2005. Milan was born on June 25, 1920 in Mountain View and grew up on the family fruit ranch on Bryant Avenue. He is survived by his wife of 58 years, Desanka Galeb Popovich; daughters, Paula Smith and Linda Roderick; sister, Olga Batey and brother, Donald. Preceded in death by brother, Robert and sister, Ruby.**

**Milan attended local schools and graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1937. He was an orchardist for the Popovich ranch on Bryant Avenue and later on the Galeb ranch in Saratoga. He was also an independent insurance agent. He was a veteran of World War II and the Korean War. He was a 67 year member of the Croatian Fraternal Union, a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association and many other organizations.**

***ELIZABETH "BETTY" E. STODDARD:*** **Passed away on February 3, 2005. A native of Mountain View. Preceded in death by her husband John Stoddard. Survived by son, Eric Stoddard; daughter, Allison Stoddard (Lenarcic) and sister, Ellen Downing.**

**Mrs. Stoddard graduated from Mountain View High School in 1940 and later was a secretary with the Los Altos School District. She was a current member of the Navy League of Santa Clara County, Quadalco and a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.**

***MARGARET VIDOVICH:*** **Passed away in Los Altos on February 20, 2005. Survived by nieces and nephews, Margaret Taylor, Susan Taylor, Lois Vidovich and Mark Vidovich. A native of Mountain View, age 90 year, Margaret retired from Ferry Morse Seed Company after 30 years as an executive secretary. She was a member of the Y.L. I., the Quota Club and was a life member of the Mountain View Historical Association.**

***MARY LOU ZOGLIN:*** **Born September 30, 1928 in York, PA and died in Mountain View on March 11, 2005. Survived by sons, John and Bill and daughter, Katie.**

**Ms. Zoglin was a former mayor of Mountain View, city council member and youth advocate. She was executive director of the non-profit, Healthy Ventures. She served on the California Community Colleges Board of Governors and the Foothill-DeAnza Community College Board. She was a life member of the Mountain View Historical Association.**

## *LIFE, HONORED AND SPECIAL MEMBERS*

**Due to our holding the newsletter to a total of 8 pages, only changes to the Life, Honored and Special Members list are noted below:**

**Only information on the deceased members noted above has changed.**